

Finnane Committee Meeting September 23rd 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bOahlsMgVDw
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Body: Finance Committee / City Council

Meeting Focus: 2026 Proposed Budget Review & Financial Discussions

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called to order the final meeting of the finance committee to review the 2026 proposed budget [00:00:28](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Selby, Garrett, House, Dishman, Green, Mason, Powell, Basham, Golian (All present [00:01:06](#)).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Council President Selby / Committee Chair.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The committee stood for the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:32](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - A motion was made and approved to suspend the rules to add the minutes from the September 3rd, 5th, and 9th meetings to the agenda for adoption (Roll call vote: Passed unanimously) [00:01:09](#)<U+2013>[00:01:50](#).

- Motion to adopt the minutes of the **September 3rd** meeting: Approved by roll call vote [00:02:10](#)<U+2013>[00:02:30](#).
 - Motion to adopt the minutes of the **September 5th** meeting: Approved by roll call vote [00:02:32](#)<U+2013>[00:03:01](#).
 - Motion to adopt the final minutes of the **September 9th** meeting: Approved by roll call vote [00:03:02](#)<U+2013>[00:03:29](#).
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:03:38](#) Administrative & Budgetary Overview

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Committee Chair / Finance Committee Members & Administration Staff (Mr. Waggle, Mr. Wright).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - The committee reviewed correspondence and answers provided by Mayor Ridenower regarding union negotiations, historical civil employee raises (noting a cumulative 21%+ raise over the past 5 years), and State Board of Accounts findings regarding Motor Vehicle Highway (MVH) restricted funds.
 - Discussion centered on the financial impact of Senate Bill 1 (SB1), which projects a \$1,436,096 reduction/deficit to be addressed in the 2026 budget.
 - The administration reported plans to subsidize the general fund with \$900,000 from EDIT funds, transition healthcare providers (from IU Health to Anthem) to achieve significant savings, implement a hiring freeze starting January 1, 2026 (excluding public safety and streets), review contracts, and explore transferring positions from full-time to part-time.
 - Committee members discussed potential line-item adjustments, including removing the deputy controller and Channel 60 director positions (which were previously cut and added back), addressing a clerical error in an overtime line item (\$48,000 discrepancy), and shifting general fund public safety positions into LIT funds post-January.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Discussion only; no formal budget amendments or votes were executed during this session. Committee members agreed to bring forward individual amendments at the formal October 6th city council meeting.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [01:05:22](#) **Rick Yenser** (Author / Resident)
 - Addressed the committee regarding county budget cuts related to IU Health clinic deals, cautioned against using EDIT funds for operations instead of business

development, and raised concerns about property tax caps, rising property values, and the tax-exempt status of major local institutions (hospital and university).

- **01:08:30 Dr. Sarah Vitali** (Representing *Muncie Resists*)
 - Expressed appreciation for the committee's public work, inquired about the public accessibility and location of budget Form 4B on the DLGF website, and emphasized the need for better administrative transparency and civic education regarding municipal finances.
- **01:13:38 Ellen Whitehead** (Resident)
 - Voiced support for the city council's willingness to defer their own raises for 2026 as a show of good faith and encouraged department heads and elected officials to consider similar sacrifices given the tight budget constraints.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Administration officials committed to providing formal documentation and verification from the health insurance company regarding projected healthcare savings by Friday.
 - The finance committee established that individual council members will draft and bring their own specific budget amendments to the formal meeting.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded with a motion to adjourn **00:10:48**. (Note: *Presiding officer briefly missed the adjournment call during public comment before successfully closing the meeting*).

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